

threat level: human

The attack vector you can't patch.

Deepfake Red Flags

A field guide to spotting AI-generated video and voice, and the scams that ride them.

\$25.6M

stolen in a single deepfake video call (Arup)

CNN / FT, 2024

0.1%

of people correctly spotted every deepfake in a test

iProov, 2025

\$40B

projected US AI-enabled fraud by 2027, from \$12.3B in 2023

Deloitte, 2024

WATCH FOR THESE

01 Urgency on a live call

A senior leader on video pressing for an immediate, secret transfer or login.

03 Camera or mic problems on cue

They will not turn on a clear camera, or quality drops the moment you ask a hard question.

05 New payment details by voice or video

Bank or wallet changes pushed in a call, never entered in the system of record.

07 Context that does not fit

An executive contacting you directly for something they would normally delegate.

02 Audio and video that drift

Lip-sync that lags, odd blinking, flat lighting, or a voice that sounds slightly off.

04 A request that skips process

Approve now, the usual approver is away, keep this between us.

06 Pressure not to verify

Discouraging a callback, a second approver, or an in-person check.

08 Emotional hooks

Panic, authority, flattery, or a manufactured crisis that rushes your judgment.

THE ONE MOVE

The one move that beats a deepfake: hang up and verify on a channel you chose. Call the person back on a known number, confirm in your finance system, or check in person. A real executive will not punish a callback. An attacker cannot survive one.

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threatlevelhuman.substack.com

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Sources: Hong Kong police / Arup (reported by CNN, FT), 2024; iProov, 2025; Deloitte Center for Financial Services, 2024. Figures as publicly reported.

How this is made: threat level: human is an AI-assisted production. A real person researches every story, checks each claim against primary sources, and is accountable for the facts.